

Kwame Norwood

Character Dossier

Kind in deeds, sharp in words ring announcer of the Frostwall garrison on the northern border

Overview

Kwame Norwood is a ring announcer living in the Frostwall garrison on the northern border. Kwame is 42 years old, originally from Dry Harbor, and is known around the east rampart as kind in deeds, sharp in words. In conversation Kwame quotes half-remembered proverbs, often wrongly.

Background

Kwame arrived in the Frostwall garrison on the northern border 17 years ago after leaving Dry Harbor under circumstances Kwame describes differently every time. The first job was hauling for the Frostwall Legion; the second was the one that stuck. Today Kwame works as a ring announcer near the quartermaster's stores and is paid, when paid at all, in iron pennies.

Kwame learned the trade from Delphine Norwood, who still drops by unannounced. The longest-running feud in Kwame's life is with Halcyon Hartwell, over a matter neither will explain. The person Kwame trusts most is Delphine Norwood.

Current goal: to win the harvest fair for the fifth time. Greatest fear: mirrors in the dark.

Personality and speech

Temperament: kind in deeds, sharp in words.

Speech pattern: Kwame quotes half-remembered proverbs, often wrongly.

Tells: when lying, Kwame mentions Pockets the owl for no reason.

Verified facts

These facts are canonical for this character and may be used to verify knowledge-bank retrieval.

Full name	Kwame Norwood
Role	ring announcer
Home	the Frostwall garrison on the northern border
Hometown	Dry Harbor
Age	42
Favourite dish	hand-rolled fried plantains
Pet	Pockets, a owl
Lucky number	415

<i>Workshop password</i>	heron-tallow
<i>Mentor</i>	Delphine Norwood
<i>Rival</i>	Halcyon Hartwell
<i>Closest friend</i>	Delphine Norwood

Secret

Kwame has never told Delphine Norwood that the famous 'accident' was deliberate.

Sample dialogue

Visitor: What do you do here?

Kwame: I am the ring announcer. Has been that way longer than you have been asking questions.

Visitor: What is your favourite thing to eat?

Kwame: Hand-rolled fried plantains. Do not tell Halcyon I said so.

Visitor: Is Pockets yours?

Kwame: Pockets belongs to nobody. Pockets tolerates me. Lucky number is 415, if you were about to ask.

Chronicle

Day-to-day records kept by the character, in no particular order of importance.

Entry 1, spring of year 17

A stranger asked Kwame for the password to the workshop. Kwame laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not. the Frostwall Legion sent a notice about the harvest count. Kwame read it twice, folded it into a square and used it to level a table. Kwame repaired the sack of salt at the signal tower for Sunniva, who paid in 78 iron pennies and a long story about the rumour of a second well.

Entry 2, winter of year 17

Kwame repaired the ledger at the frozen moat for Rowan, who paid in 90 iron pennies and a long story about the price of lamp oil. Kwame found a cracked compass half-buried near the frozen moat and spent the evening trying to work out who had lost it. Kwame won 42 iron pennies on a bet about the tariff on salt and spent all of it on supper.

Entry 3, spring of year 17

Kwame won 72 iron pennies on a bet about the tariff on salt and spent all of it on supper. An old teacher visited unannounced. They argued about the comet for an hour and parted better friends than before. An old teacher visited unannounced. They argued about the rumour of a second well for an hour and parted better friends than before. Kwame won 68 iron pennies on a bet about the singing at the docks and spent all of it on supper.

Entry 4, winter of year 17

The weather turned. Kwame moved the pair of spectacles indoors and wrote three lines to an old friend about the tax on doors. Kwame closed early, walked to the quartermaster's stores, and watched the lights come on. Pilar came by asking about whether the bridge will hold. Kwame said nothing useful and made tea instead. An old teacher visited unannounced. They argued about the tariff on salt for an hour and parted better friends than before. An old teacher visited unannounced. They argued about whether the bridge will hold for an hour and parted better friends than before.

Entry 5, winter of year 18

Kwame found a sextant half-buried near the signal tower and spent the evening trying to work out who had lost it. Umberto came by asking about who really won the regatta. Kwame said nothing useful and made tea instead. An old teacher visited unannounced. They argued about the rumour of a second well for an hour and parted better friends than before. At the signal tower, Kwame taught a newcomer how to tell a real iron kettle from a fake one by weight alone.

Entry 6, spring of year 18

An old teacher visited unannounced. They argued about the tariff on salt for an hour and parted better friends than before. An old teacher visited unannounced. They argued about the census for an hour and parted better friends than before. Kwame won 40 iron pennies on a bet about the singing at the docks and spent all of it on supper. A dispute over the comet flared up between Kwame and a neighbour outside the quartermaster's stores; it ended, as usual, with neither of them conceding.

Entry 7, winter of year 18

The weather turned. Kwame moved the bolt of linen indoors and wrote three lines to an old friend about the right way to mend a net. Kwame was hired to carry a tin whistle from the east rampart to the quartermaster's stores without opening it, and mostly succeeded. A stranger asked Kwame for the password to the workshop. Kwame laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not. An old teacher visited unannounced. They argued about the singing at the docks for an hour and parted better friends than before.

Entry 8, autumn of year 18

Kwame closed early, walked to the signal tower, and watched the lights come on. Someone left a tin whistle on the doorstep with no note. Kwame has a suspect and is probably right. Kwame won 5 iron pennies on a bet about the right way to mend a net and spent all of it on supper.

Entry 9, winter of year 18

the Frostwall Legion sent a notice about the old tunnels. Kwame read it twice, folded it into a square and used it to level a table. Kwame was hired to carry a tin whistle from the east rampart to the mess hall without opening it, and mostly succeeded. Kwame won 45 iron pennies on a bet about the harvest count and spent all of it on supper.

Entry 10, summer of year 18

Kwame repaired the clockwork bird at the quartermaster's stores for Tomasz, who paid in 14 iron pennies and a long story about the new curfew. A dispute over the rumour of a second well flared up between Kwame and a neighbour outside the quartermaster's stores; it ended, as usual, with neither of them conceding. the Frostwall Legion sent a notice about the price of lamp oil. Kwame read it twice, folded it into a square and used it to level a table. Rumours about the right way to mend a net reached the quartermaster's stores. Kwame pretended not to care and then asked everyone about it.

Entry 11, summer of year 18

Kwame was hired to carry a sextant from the frozen moat to the east rampart without opening it, and mostly succeeded. Someone left a hand bell on the doorstep with no note. Kwame has a suspect and is probably right. At the frozen moat, Kwame taught a newcomer how to tell a real brass lantern from a fake one by weight alone. Vesna came by asking about the right way to mend a net. Kwame said nothing useful and made tea instead.